

Fiscal Year 2023–24 City of Portland Shelter Services



Shelter Services
STREETS TO STABILITY

"If there's something that I believe people don't understand about the houseless community, it's that they're just people. They're the same as you. They're the same as me. They're the same as anybody else walking the earth. It is really that simple."

– **Ashley**, Program manager
at River District Navigation
Center, who has experience
living unsheltered



LOOKING FORWARD:
CONTINUALLY
IMPROVING OUR
APPROACH AND
SERVICES

This year has been one of growth and maturation for our program. We are listening, learning and adapting to give the best to each of those we serve. While this report reflects successes from last fiscal year, here is what excites us about the future:

- The creativity of our partners in diversifying their services and support to meet each person’s individual needs.
- Our program is expanding. Two sites have increased their capacity, and a third new site will open in the coming months. Together this represents an additional 292 sleeping units (tiny homes and RVs) which can accommodate up to two people.
- We’ve begun monthly peer-to-peer learning workshops for staff from all our shelters.
- We’ve developed and are expanding Health and Wellness spaces in our villages to support those working on recovery.



From Our Director

The underlying systemic issues leading to all time high homelessness rates in our community may be different from the natural and human made disasters that I’ve witnessed across the globe, but the results are similar: displacement, trauma, and disruption. There are clear parallels among the individuals experiencing humanitarian crises abroad and here at home — all have been failed by systems and people that hold power. **And all deserve to have a voice and opportunity.**

As a humanitarian responder, I knew that what we accomplished quickly would not be perfect, yet taking no action would be unacceptable. The City of Portland recognizes that this humanitarian crisis requires innovation, collaboration, and action. This is why I am deeply proud of the connections and partnerships that have been forged by the City and our partners. What we’re seeing in our streets and at our shelters is a fast growing and aging population of individuals with a significant occurrence of chronic illness, disabilities, mental and behavioral health challenges, and substance use disorder, sometimes predating homelessness and always exacerbated by the trauma of living unsheltered. Our shelter providers are going above and beyond to learn, adapt and meet the needs of the people they serve.

We’ve increased services at each of our sites and built integral partnerships with dozens of other providers and nonprofits. From mental and behavioral health on-site support via Mental Health and Addiction Advocates of Oregon (MHA AO) to employment connections via Central City Concern to mobile health, dental and even veterinary clinics with scheduled visits at our sites. We’re seeing more and more guests at our shelters voluntarily enter detox, treatment, and recovery programs during their stay.

Our low barrier shelters are designed to support people in their transition from the streets to stability. That doesn’t just look like a tiny home pod with a warm bed to sleep in, showers and laundry for hygiene and food for sustenance — though all are incredibly important. It means empowering and preparing our guests to be successful in housing, such as our partnership with RentWell, a tenant education program through Transition Projects, and with Sunstone Way (previously All Good NW) and their housing retention specialists who support former guests as they transition out of temporary shelter and into housing.

Ultimately, it will take all the actors within this system to address the crisis we’re facing. **Together, and only together, we can shift the tides toward change.**

– Brandy Westerman

Emergency Humanitarian Operations Director overseeing the Shelter Services program, came to this role with 20+ years experience managing humanitarian operations internationally.

WHO WE SERVE

July 2022 Through June 2024

1,800 total people served

32% Female	69% Identify as Having One or More Disability
61% Male	
3% Non-Binary	40% of All People Sheltered Reported as Non-White or Multiracial
2% Transgender	

860 chronically homeless (45% of total served)

1,064 people exited shelter of those 1,064,

491 of those 491, 256 went to temporary or permanent housing

were chronically homeless



This Year in Numbers*

MORE THAN 210,000 nights of safe sleep (Estimated total number of nights someone was sleeping in one of our 576 sleeping units during this period.)

9 shelters

83 partner organizations supported the work of our shelter operators

576 sleeping units (including tiny homes, RVs and shelter beds)

* THIS YEAR REPRESENTS 8 SITES OVER A FULL YEAR FROM JULY 1, 2023 - JUNE 30, 2024, PLUS ONE CONGREGATE SHELTER FOR SIX MONTHS FROM JAN. 1, 2024 - JUNE 30, 2024.

We recognize each person is unique, that they have different needs, and we work with them to identify and meet those needs.



LISTENING
GREAT STAFF
PATIENCE
ADAPTIBILITY
PROVIDING COMMUNITY

MORE THAN BASIC NEEDS

What makes our shelters with services successful?

TAKE THE TIME TO EARN TRUST
LIVED EXPERIENCE
NIMBLE
ALWAYS LEARNING
SERVICES TAILORED TO PEOPLE'S NEEDS

PATRICK’S STORY

When Patrick parked at Sunderland RV Safe Park, he finally felt safe. “I felt relief,” he said, after living out of an RV in Portland for 5 years, homeless ever since he’d unexpectedly lost his house, unable to work due to sudden health issues.

“My life was in chaos, living in my RV with my dogs and being moved from location to location around the city,” Patrick said. “It wasn’t really living, more like trying to survive.” Over the past year, site staff built trust with Patrick, connecting him to much-needed resources, helping transport him to doctor’s appointments – even taking care of his dog while he was in the hospital. Today, Patrick is settling into his new apartment.

“(I spent) the last five years being afraid, wondering ‘am I gonna have food and is my RV gonna be there when I get back?’ Now I don’t have to worry about that.”

JESSICA’S STORY

Jessica was 14 years old when she slept outside for the first time. Through her youth and early adulthood, she struggled through addiction and instability. Last summer, she accepted the offer of a tiny home pod at Reedway. “I felt like I stepped into a different world when I would come back to the village...eventually there was a strong pull to go back every night,” Jessica said. By December, Jessica’s care coordinator had earned her trust, and helped the 26-year-old secure a housing voucher.

“At first, I didn’t really believe it,” Jessica said. “... that never felt like an option for me. I remember getting tired being out for hours canning when I was homeless, but I just didn’t want to go back to my tent...I would walk by people’s houses and smell dinner, and it would make me so depressed. Now... I can go make some food at my own home.”

HELPING SOMEONE IN NEED
(GERALD AND MARCIA)

For many years on his way to work, Gerald passed by a man living on a park bench in SW Portland. “When I met Mike, he couldn’t tell you his last name, his birthdate, he didn’t have any memorable history,” Gerald said. No one knows for sure how long Mike sat on that bench, but several neighbors recall seeing him for at least a decade. Gerald forged a friendship with Mike, helping him stay warm in the winters, bringing clothes and food, and driving him to community centers for a shower. Eventually, Mike started called Gerald “grandpa.” When Mike’s campsite was posted for removal, Gerald was one of many “community caretakers” who stepped in to problem solve. With the help of Marcia, a nearby neighbor, Gerald connected with the City Outreach Team who built trust with Mike as he transitioned to a tiny home pod at Clinton Triangle. Afterward, Marcia posted a sign at his park bench to be sure all the people who knew Mike wouldn’t worry about him. “Mike has a new home,” the sign said. “It made me happy that I could do something for somebody,” Marcia said. “I overcame that feeling of helplessness that can so easily turn into anger and compassion fatigue... And it wasn’t much, but it was something.”

SITE	SLEEPING UNITS	DATE OPEN
BIPOC	38	JULY '21
CLINTON TRIANGLE	160	JULY '23
MENLO PARK	50	DEC. '22
MULTNOMAH	28	JUNE '22
PENINSULA CROSSING	60	MAY '23
QUEER AFFINITY	35	JUNE '22
REEDWAY	60	JULY '23
RIVER DIST. NAV. CTR.	90	2019
SUNDERLAND RV PARK	55	JULY '23



576 total units
(including tiny homes, RVs and shelter beds) from July 2023 to June 2024.

FOSTERING

Partnerships

GOVERNMENT PARTNERS

Joint Office of Homeless Services
Oregon Department of Transportation
Port of Portland
Prosper Portland
TriMet
Metro

SHELTER OPERATORS

Cultivate Initiatives
Sunstone Way
The Salvation Army
Transition Projects
Urban Alchemy



SERVICES AND SUPPLIERS

3v3ryday Grind
4D Recovery
American Plaza Condos
Animal Aid
Another Chance Rehab
Art With Katie
Birch Community Services
Blackburn Clinic
Boulder Care
Bridges Middle School
Calvary Chapel Community Church, Tigard
Care Oregon
Cascadia Behavioral Health
Central City Concern
Central City Concern Mobile Health Unit
Coastal Farm
Coda
Community Health Assessment Team (CHAT)
Dinner and a Movie
Do Good Multnomah
Everybody Bikes
Feed the Mass

Feral Cat Society
Fora Health Treatment & Recovery
Friends of Multnomah Safe Rest Village
Friends of Portland Community Gardens
Going Home 2
Goodwill Industries
Great Circle Recovery
Greyhound + Market Street + Gresham Women's Shelter
Homebase Recovery
Housing Connector
HRBR (Harm Reduction Bridges to Care)
Independent Living Resources RentWell
International School of Portland
Letty Owings
Lion Laughs ENT
Meals on Wheels
Multnomah County Health
Multnomah County Library
NW Pilot Project
NW Recovery Works

OHSU Bridges to Collaborative Care Clinic
OHSU Food Innovation Center
Old Town Clinic
Oregon Health Authority
Oregon Humane Society
Oregon Recovery Residences Registry
Our Just Future
P:ear
PATH Program
Pathfinders
Pearl District Neighborhood Association
Pets on Broadway
Pine Street Recovery
Portland Animal Welfare Team
Portland Community College CLEAR Clinic
Portland Fire Department
Portland Rescue Mission
Portland Street Medicine
Portland Street Response
Project Nurture
Project Respond

Promoting Access to Health
Providence Health Systems
RadioCab + Ride2Care
Rose Haven
SE Works
Sober Housing Oregon LLC
Sober PDX
Speed's Towing
Street Books
Synergy (Rapid Response)
The Mental Health & Addiction Association of Oregon
The Salvation Army
Tivnu
TriMet
Troutdale Animal Shelter
Union Gospel Mission
VA Community Resource Center
Violence Prevention Outreach Program (City of Portland)
Westside Watershed Resource Council
WorkSource Oregon

2023-2024

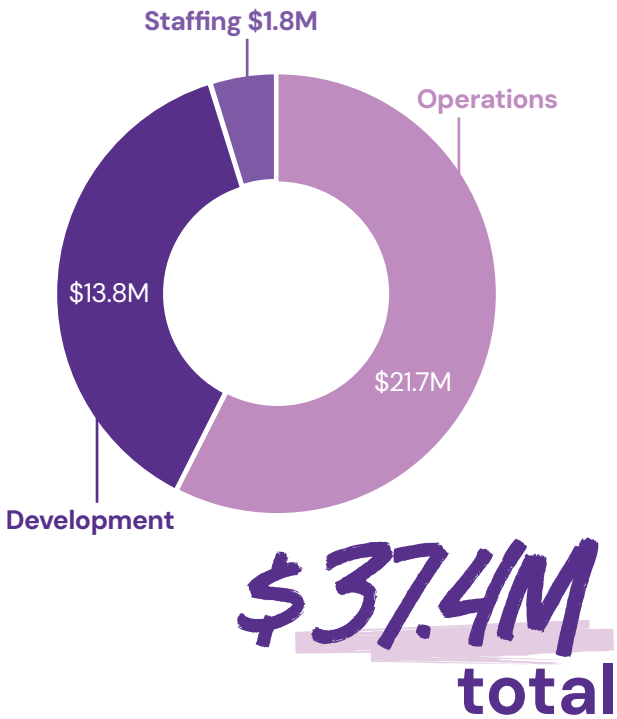
Finances



Expenses (FY23-24)

Expenses represent funds used from July 1, 2023, through June 30, 2024. They cover three general categories:

- **Operations** includes programmatic costs for shelters. Some funds are passed through from the City to Multnomah County's Joint Office of Homeless Services, others are paid directly to shelter operators, utilities, and contractors.
- **Development** represents funds used to expand capacity at two existing sites (Multnomah and Reedway) and to create the N. Portland Rd shelter. Expansions are anticipated to open in late September 2024, with N. Portland Rd shelter opening later this year.
- **Staffing** represents costs for the small team at the City that oversees the program – everything from supporting our shelter operators, working with communities around each village, collaborating with other agencies, site development, and sharing the stories of our program.



Three Year Budget (2021-24)

TOTAL BUDGET AND FUNDING SOURCES 2021-2024:

\$45.2M	FEDERAL AMERICAN RESCUE PLAN ACT	\$2.2M	CITY GENERAL FUND
\$0.54M	FEDERAL CARES ACT	\$12.1M	STATE (OREGON ALL IN)
\$6.1M	METRO SUPPORTIVE HOUSING SERVICES	\$1M	STATE (ADMIN. SERVICES GRANT)

\$67M
total

Shelter Services

STREETS TO STABILITY



Stories Worth Sharing

While our program is data-driven, focusing on metrics and outcomes to improve our operations, it is the unique and **deeply personal journeys of the individuals** our shelters serve that truly define our success. Every data point represents the varied, complex backgrounds of people whose stories are often filled with trauma, disappointments, and setbacks, but also **resilience, hope, and transformation.**



Stranded in the January 2024 winter storm, Brandi and her husband were living in their car when they were offered refuge at Clinton Triangle. Six months later, they are housed.



Chris, age 46, said staying at a low-barrier City shelter has given him the much-needed safe space to recover from half a lifetime unsheltered.



Driven by her mother's legacy of compassion and service, Brandy Westerman reflects on her transition from international humanitarian aid work to tackling Portland's homelessness crisis as the City's Emergency Humanitarian Operations Director.



Nine months ago, Tehanna Welch learned she was pregnant while homeless. Today, she and her partner are housed and expecting their first child.

Read their [stories](#) on the Streets to Stability blog and take a look at our [data dashboard](#) at portland.gov/shelter-services



Shelter Services

PORTLAND SOLUTIONS

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